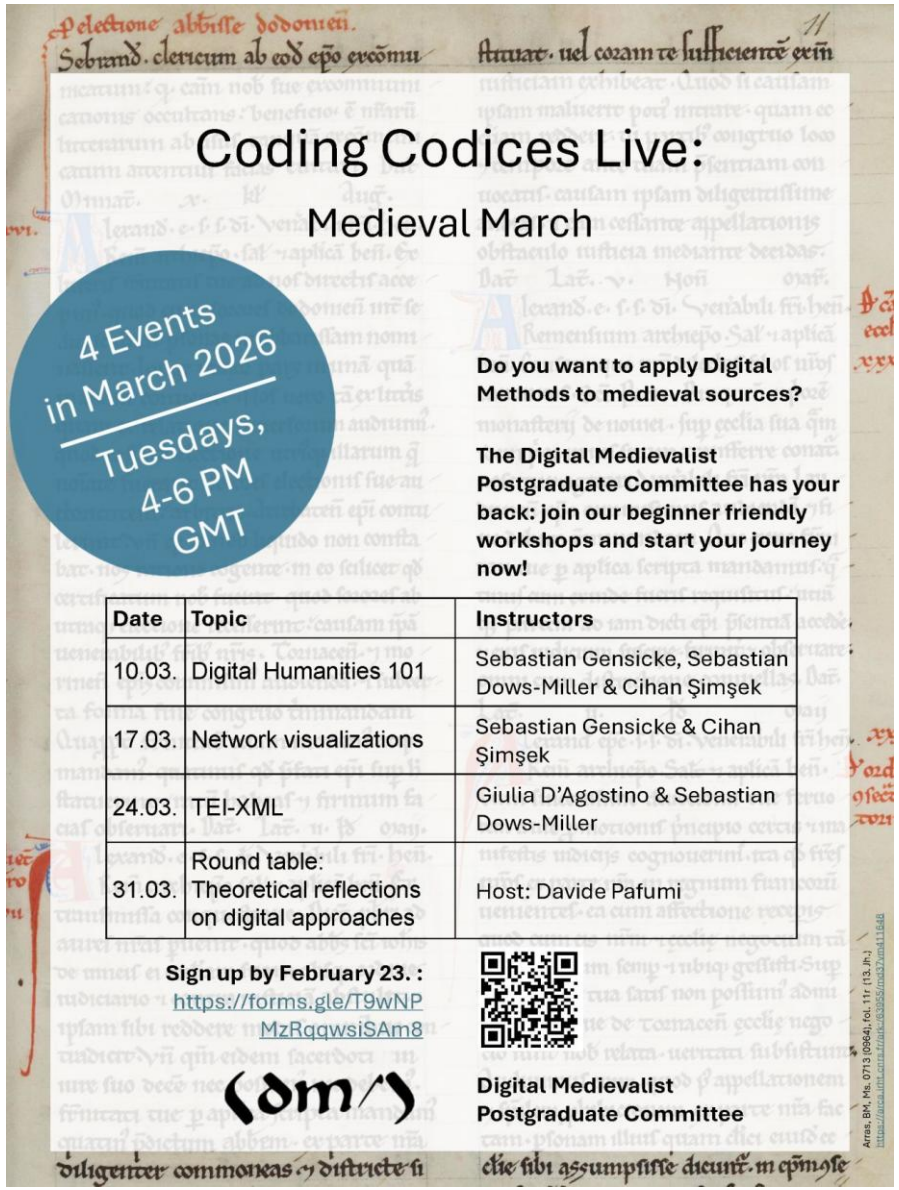
TEI-XML

Structural elements and the TEI header



Agenda

- 5:30–5:40pm CET: Introduction to structural elements
- 5:40–5:50pm CET: Introduction to the TEI header
- 5:50–6:00pm CET: Question time

Structural elements

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In the beginning was the Text…

TEI element text (text)

<text>

Home
C Elements

<text> (text) contains a single text of any kind, whether unitary or composite, for example a poem or drama, a collection of essays, a novel, a dictionary, or a corpus sample. [4 Default Text Structure 16.1 Varieties of Composite Text]

Module	textstructure — Default Text Structure

<front> (front matter) contains any prefatory matter (headers, abstracts, title page, prefaces, dedications, etc.) found at the start of a document, before the main body.
<body> (text body) contains the whole body of a single unitary text, excluding any front or back matter.
<group> (group) contains the body of a composite text, grouping together a sequence of distinct texts (or groups of such texts) which are regarded as a unit for some purpose, for example the collected works of an author, a sequence of prose essays, etc.
<back> (back matter) contains any appendixes, etc. following the main part of a text.

In the beginning was the Text…

4 Default Text Structure - The TEI Guidelines

4.1 Divisions of the Body

3.11.3 Milestone Elements

Poetry is the spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings…

6 Verse - The TEI Guidelines

Recap

- Milestones: <pb>, <lb>, <cb>
- Prose paragraph: <p>
- Verse line: <l>

Something useful

- TEI element seg (arbitrary segment)
- 3.3.3 Quotation

The TEI header

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Document your work and encode your object’s metadata

2 The TEI Header - The TEI Guidelines

Obligatory elements

```
<teiHeader>
  <fileDesc>
    <titleStmt>
      <title>Title</title>
    </titleStmt>
    <publicationStmt>
      <p>Publication Information</p>
    </publicationStmt>
    <sourceDesc>
      <p>Information about the source</p>
    </sourceDesc>
  </fileDesc>
</teiHeader>
```

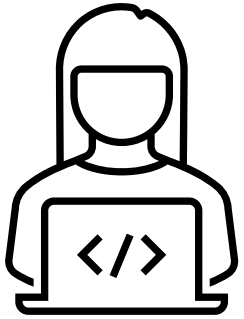
The five main components

1. a *file description*, tagged fileDesc, containing a full bibliographical description of the computer file itself, from which a user of the text could derive a proper bibliographic citation, or which a librarian or archivist could use in creating a catalogue entry recording its presence within a library or archive. The term *computer file* here is to be understood as referring to the whole entity or document described by the header, even when this is stored in several distinct operating system files. The file description also includes information about the source or sources from which the electronic document was derived. The TEI elements used to encode the file description are described in section 2.2 The File Description below.
2. an *encoding description*, tagged encodingDesc, which describes the relationship between an electronic text and its source or sources. It allows for detailed description of whether (or how) the text was normalized during transcription, how the encoder resolved ambiguities in the source, what levels of encoding or analysis were applied, and similar matters. The TEI elements used to encode the encoding description are described in section 2.3 The Encoding Description below.
3. a *text profile*, tagged profileDesc, containing classificatory and contextual information about the text, such as its subject matter, the situation in which it was produced, the individuals described by or participating in producing it, and so forth. Such a text profile is of particular use in highly structured composite texts such as corpora or language collections, where it is often highly desirable to enforce a controlled descriptive vocabulary or to perform retrievals from a body of text in terms of text type or origin. The text profile may however be of use in any form of automatic text processing. The TEI elements used to encode the profile description are described in section 2.4 The Profile Description below.
4. a container element, tagged xenoData, which allows easy inclusion of metadata from non-TEI schemes (i.e., other than elements in the TEI namespace). For example, the MARC record for the encoded document might be included using MARCXML or MODS. A simple set of metadata for harvesting might be included encoded in Dublin Core.
5. a *revision history*, tagged revisionDesc, which allows the encoder to provide a history of changes made during the development of the electronic text. The revision history is important for *version control* and for resolving questions about the history of a file. The TEI elements used to encode the revision description are described in section 2.6 The Revision Description below.

To describe your medieval manuscripts…

```
<teiHeader>
  <fileDesc>
    <titleStmt>
      <title>Title</title>
    </titleStmt>
    <publicationStmt>
      <p>Publication Information</p>
    </publicationStmt>
    <sourceDesc>
      <p>Information about the source</p>
    </sourceDesc>
  </fileDesc>
</teiHeader>
```

11 Manuscript Description - The TEI Guidelines



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…and now on to the hands-on session!